

ITALY 2013

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1. Overview of the tax-benefit system

1.1. Average Worker wage (AW)

The national currency is the Euro (EUR). In 2013, EUR 0.78 was equal to USD 1. In that year the average worker earned EUR 29 704 (Secretariat estimate).

2. Unemployment insurance

There were three main types of unemployment benefits available prior to 2013: a) Ordinary unemployment benefits (included in our model up to and including 2012), b) Wage supplementation funds (known as *Cassa Integrazione Guadagni* – henceforth CIG, either ordinary or special), and c) Mobility benefits.

The reform of the unemployment benefits presented in 2011 was introduced gradually starting in 2013 and will be in full operation in 2017. This reform changed the former scheme in a radical way. The new *Assicurazione Sociale per l'Impiego* (ASPI), Social Insurance for Employment replaces ordinary unemployment benefits and mobility benefits. In our modelling, the ASPI has replaced the Ordinary Unemployment Benefits from 2013.

Unemployment insurance is compulsory for private sector employees. Unemployment benefits are paid only to workers who were hired with permanent or fixed term contracts, while ‘atypical workers’ who pay social security contributions to a special fund known as ‘*gestione separata*’ are not eligible for these benefits.

2.1 Conditions for receipt

ASPI (replacing Ordinary unemployment benefits) is provided to individuals insured with the National Social Security Institute (*Istituto Nazionale per la Previdenza Sociale*, INPS) for at least two years and having accumulated at least 52 weeks of contributions in the two years preceding the ending of the employment. ASPI will be assigned regardless of the sector the worker belongs to, his or her professional qualification and the size of the business. It will be extended to categories hitherto excluded, such as apprentices and members of cooperatives.

Mobility benefits are provided in case of collective dismissals by firms eligible for benefit from the CIGs and in case of individual dismissal of workers already in CIGs or under bankruptcy proceedings.¹

Workers receiving mobility benefits and CIGs are eligible for Socially Useful Jobs (*Lavori Socialmente Utili* or LSU), usually lasting 12 months (albeit prorogation for other 12 months is possible). Workers receiving mobility benefits have to compulsorily accept these jobs if they are asked to, otherwise they will lose their benefit. After 2002 LSU programs are under progressive dismantling.

If employed in LSU, workers receiving CIGs and mobility benefits maintain their benefit until it elapses. Afterwards, if they are still employed in LSU, they will receive a benefit of EUR 503.92 per month, which is the amount paid for LSU if the workers involved are not receiving any other benefit. Workers on mobility and CIGs are not the only ones eligible for LSU. Unemployed workers with an unemployment spell of at least two years which usually do not receive any income support are also eligible.

2.2 Calculation of benefit amount

2.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

- a) In the case of ASPI, the benefit is 75% of the previous pay for wages below EUR 1,180, while for wages higher than this threshold the benefit is increased by 25% of the difference between the worker's wage and this threshold. However, the maximum amount cannot exceed a given amount defined by the Law (1,152.90 in 2013). The benefit is reduced by 15% after the first six months of

1. Generally, mobility benefits are limited to collective dismissals (firms that have dismissed at least 5 workers in 120 days) in the manufacturing sector excluding firms with less than 15 workers.

unemployment, 30% in the following six months. Workers must have paid social insurance contributions for at least one year in the two years prior unemployment.

- b) CIG (both Ordinary and Special) is 80 per cent of the average gross earnings paid for non-worked hours, with a maximum level of the benefit equal to that of unemployment benefits.
- c) Mobility benefits equal CIGs for the first 12 months. They are reduced by 20 per cent after one year, with a maximum level of benefit equal to that of unemployment benefits.

Mini - ASPI

The amount payable for the Mini-ASPI is the same as that for the full ASPI. The duration of benefit receipt is limited to 50% of the contribution record for the past 12 months.

2.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards for benefit recipients and those starting a new job*

See below (income and earnings disregards)

2.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

Unemployment benefits are not means-tested and family benefits can be paid on top of them. It is not possible to receive a certain amount of earnings from work and still be receiving unemployment benefits except for the CIG schemes which intervene for work interruptions.

2.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

Tax treatment of benefit

All these benefits are taxable; concerning social security contribution, the general rule is that benefits replacing less than 80 per cent of previous income are exempt. Hence, only unemployment benefits and mobility benefits after the first year are exempt from social security contributions (although imputed contributions are attributed to the benefit recipients; this imputed contributions are not affected by the temporarily increase in the ordinary unemployment benefit, which concerns just the benefit paid to workers).

2.4 *Benefit duration and waiting periods*

- a) The duration of ASPI for the transitory period 2013-2015 is reported in Table 1.

Table 1. Duration of ASPI

Year of the employment ending	Age of worker		
	Less than 50 years	Equal or more than 50 years but less than 55 years	Equal or more than 55 years
2013	8 months	12 months	12 months
2014	8 months	12 months	14 months
2015	10 months	12 months	16 months

- a) Unemployment benefits are paid monthly, for a maximum of 8 months after a 7-day waiting period. For unemployed aged over-50 the duration is extended to 12 months. In the case of mini-ASPI, duration is equal to half of the number of days previously worked in the last 12 months.
- b) CIGo (ordinary CIG) is usually paid for 13 weeks but it is possible to obtain some prorogation if the firm remains in a reduction of activity for a longer period. In any case, CIGo cannot be paid for more than 12 months, whether consecutive or non-consecutive, over a period of two years.
- c) CIGs (special CIG) is normally paid for 12 up to 24 months (the length depending on the type of difficulties that the firm faces as well as on the restructuring strategy). It is possible to obtain prorogation if restructuring lasts more than 24 months. In any case, CIGs cannot be paid for more than 36 months over 5 years.
- d) The duration of mobility benefits depends on the age of the recipient and on the location of the job. For instance, workers under 40 are entitled to this benefit for 12 or 24 months, respectively, according to whether they had been working in the Centre-North or the South of Italy. Conversely, the benefit duration is extended up to 36 or 48 months respectively for workers over 50 (see Table 2 below).

Table 2. Duration of mobility benefits by age of the worker and geographical location*

Age	Location	
	Centre - North	South
< 40	1 year	2 years
40 – 49	2 years	3 years
> 49	3 years	4 years

* In any case, duration cannot be longer than length of tenure in the last occupation.

2.5 *Treatment of particular groups*

None

2.5.1 *Young persons*

2.5.2 *Older workers*

Longer durations of the benefits are established for older workers (see section 2.4).

2.5.3 *Others if applicable*

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2013**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

3. Unemployment assistance

No Unemployment Assistance scheme is available.

3.1 Conditions for receipt

3.1.1 *Employment conditions*

3.1.2 *Contribution conditions*

3.2 Calculation of benefit amount

3.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

3.2.1.1 *Irregular additional payments*

3.2.1.2 *Obligations of family members*

3.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards for benefit recipients and those starting a new job*

3.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

3.4 Benefit duration and waiting periods

3.5 Treatment of particular groups

3.5.1 *Young persons*

3.5.2 *Older workers*

3.5.3 *Others if applicable*

4. Social assistance

Italy does not provide a universal income support scheme, except for a social benefit (the so-called *Assegno Sociale* – “social allowance” – previously known as *pensione sociale* – “social pension”) covering people aged over 65 without other sources of income. At local level there can be some provisions for people in need, but these initiatives do not follow national guidelines.

4.1 Conditions for receipt

Assegno sociale: the benefit amounts to EUR 442.30 per month (thirteen payments in one year) for income not exceeding EUR 5,749.90 (in case of non-married recipients) and EUR 11,499.80 (if related to a couple). The benefit is paid on a differential basis and is exempted from taxation.

4.2 Calculation of benefit amount

4.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

4.2.1.1 Irregular additional payments

4.2.1.2 Obligations of family members

4.2.2 Income and earnings disregards for benefit recipients and those starting a new job

Assegno sociale: eligibility is based on individual or income of the couple when individuals are married, after income tax and social insurance contributions. Imputed income from the main house of residence (cadastral rent) is excluded from income, as well as severance payments, while any non-taxable source of income and family benefits (*Assegni al nucleo familiare*, see below) are included in this income base. The benefit is tax-exempt.

4.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

4.4 Benefit duration and waiting periods

4.5 Treatment of particular group

4.5.1 Young persons

4.5.2 Older workers

4.5.3 Others if applicable

5. Housing benefits for rented accommodation

In Italy housing policies are addressed both to those who buy the main house of residence (usually in the form of tax allowances related to mortgage loan interests up to a threshold of EUR 4,000, rebates on property transfer taxes; low interest loans which are means-tested and regulated by local legislation, all in the case of first-time buyers) as well as to those who rent a house.

The rent assistance provisions usually take the form of :

- a) Means-tested tax reliefs.
- b) Rent subsidies for low-income people. These subsidies are provided at local level but have a very low coverage. They are discussed in this report, however no funding was made available to this scheme in 2012 and 2013, therefore they are not included in the model results.
- c) Rent-limiting legislation, mainly regulated at local level. This consists of restrictions to rent increases for those with a rental agreement.
- d) Controlled rents for State-owned dwellings.

There is typically no difference between national rules for pensioners and recipients in their income ages, with the exception of some benefits provided at local level and addressed to the poor and the elderly (over 65). Exceptions occurring for the means tested tax reliefs are described below.

5.1 Conditions for receipt

- a) Tax credits are granted to people on rent for the main house of residence, if they have an 'affordable rent contract' (contratti convenzionati); these reliefs are means-tested against taxable income.
- b) Rent subsidies are granted whenever household taxable income falls short of twice the amount of the statutory minimum pension ($\text{EUR } 6\,441 \times 2 = 12\,882$ per year) and the rent exceeds 14 per cent of this income. Such requirements can be modified at local level. These subsidies are conditional on the availability of funds. The central government decides how much resources are allocated to the National Fund for Rental Support (Fondo nazionale di sostegno alle locazioni). These resources are then distributed across regions, who can match them with their own resources. Regions also define the eligibility threshold – both in terms of household income and rent as share of income. The fund is then distributed among municipalities in each region that manage its delivery. For 2012 and 2013 the government allocated no resources to this fund. As such, no local funding is assumed either and therefore this benefit is not modelled for 2012 and 2013.
- c) Dependent on rental agreement.
- d) Limited rents - known as social rents - for people with low-income (below twice the amount of the statutory minimum pension), are set for some categories of State-owned dwellings. Eligibility is based on the family size and claimants are ranked in a list set by the municipalities. It is also important to add that most of the stock of buildings so rented, have been attributed in the past, and the new additions are relatively small. State-owned dwellings, specifically those owned by the Social Security State Agencies, are generally rented at preferential prices, usually below market rents.

5.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

- a) The Italian tax system provides rent tax reliefs to households who rent their main house of residence. The amount of tax relief depends on the household's gross income. Two specific thresholds are used: EUR 15,493.71 (y1) and EUR 30,987.41 (y2); no credit is provided if income is greater than y2. The tax allowance amounts to EUR 300.00 if income is lower than y1 and EUR 150.00 if income is between y1 and y2. A greater tax allowance is granted to: (1) households with affordable rent contracts ("contratti convenzionali"); (2) people aged between 20 and 30, in the first three years of residence; (3) dependent workers who move to a different place because of work, in the first three years of residence. The tax allowance amounts to EUR 495.80 (1); EUR 991.60 (2 and 3) if income is lower than y1 and to EUR 247.90 (1); EUR 495.84 (3) if income ranges between y1 and y2. A tax allowance equal to 19% of rent is also granted to university students who "study away from their hometown" as long as the rent is no higher than EUR 2,633. Tax payers can claim for the total credit in the same year (although it usually takes several years before the credit is actually paid from the Department) or carry it forward and deduct it from the next year's income tax.
- b) Rent subsidies differ in eligibility conditions and benefit amounts at the regional as well as at the municipality level. Moreover, the maximum amount varies with the size of the city's population. In some municipalities eligibility depends also on the household wealth and resources can be means-tested through a partially modified ISE.
- c) Rent-limiting legislation varies according to regional provisions.

5.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

5.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

5.2.3 *Costs eligible for housing benefits*

5.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

5.4 *Treatment of particular groups*

5.4.1 *Young persons*

5.4.2 *Older workers*

5.4.3 *Others if applicable*

6. Family benefits**6.1 Conditions for receipt**

- a) Family allowances. The benefit is means-tested against total household taxable income. A household is defined as the recipient, his/her spouse, and his/her dependent child/children under 18. The benefit is not only devoted to families with children and for instance a low-income couple with no children is eligible for the benefit. The family allowance scheme grants cash transfers to employees and former-employee pensioners and unemployment benefit recipients, but does not cover self-employed..
- b) Maternity allowances, enacted in 1999, are granted by municipalities and are addressed to mothers with children below 1 year of age. The benefit is means-tested and ISE must be below a given threshold. Generally speaking, beneficiaries are unemployed housewives or job seekers.
- c) Allowances to households with at least three children under 18, enacted in 1999, are addressed to households with at least three children younger than 18, whose ISE lies below a given threshold.

In 2009 a new temporary measure devoted to fighting poverty was introduced, the so-called *Social Card*. This was also confirmed in 2013.

Social card: this is a voucher (in the form of a pre-paid credit card) amounting to EUR 40 per month that can be used to buy groceries and pay the energy and gas bills. Recipients can be either aged over 65 or less than 3 years old (in this case actually the benefit recipient is the parent). Eligibility is based on very strict conditions (see table 2).

Table 2 – Eligibility rules for the Social card.

	Recipients aged over 65	Recipients aged less the 3
Recipients must be below the tax threshold (their income must not be chargeable to the income tax)	X	
Pension and social assistance benefits (lower than EUR 6,499.82 if aged less than 70, EUR 8,666.43 if aged over 70)	X	
Equivalent household income lower than EUR 6,499.82 (computed using the ISE equivalence scale, see table 4).	X	X
Holder of electricity and gas contracts	X	X
Car owners	X	X
Owner (by at least 25%) of house of residence	X	X
(equivalent) Financial wealth (computed using the ISE equivalence scale) below EUR 15,000	X	X

6.2 Calculation of benefit amount

6.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

Family allowances are cash transfers that vary with the number of family members and household taxable income. The benefit is paid by employers on behalf of the National Social Security Institute (*Istituto Nazionale per la Previdenza Sociale*, INPS) and the income brackets are adjusted yearly to the consumer price index. The scheme covers different household typologies, ranging from households where both spouses are present (with or without children), to orphaned individuals, to divorced, separated, widowed recipients, or individuals with spouse living in a foreign country. Eligible households include the recipient, his/her spouse, children if aged less than 18 or 21 when they are students (or 26 if living in households with at least 4 children), dependent grandchildren, brothers or sisters. Household income includes taxable as well as non-taxable income. Eligibility to the benefit requires that income be at least 70 per cent of income from dependent work or pensions from dependent work.

Part-time workers receive the entire amount of the benefit if they work at least 24 hours per week, while if they work less than 24 hours the benefit is reduced depending on the number of days worked. For instance, if the recipient works only one day then the benefit is 1/6 of the full amount. It should be noted that if the recipient works a few hours every day of the week then no reduction applies since the reduction depends on the number of days worked rather than the number of hours.

Maternity allowances granted by municipalities amount to EUR 324.79 for five months (EUR 1,623.95 per year) and are granted to mothers whose ISE (see section 1, note 1) lies below a given threshold or do not earn income. In the case of insured mothers receiving maternity benefits smaller than this amount, the allowance is paid on a differential basis. For a three three-member family the threshold is EUR 33,857.51, while for households with different size the threshold is modified according to the equivalence scale in Table 4.

Another scheme of maternity allowance is provided at national level and is addressed to mothers who have resigned their job during their pregnancy and have paid contributions for at least three months over the period between 18 and 9 months preceding birth. Mothers who receive this benefit are not eligible for other maternity allowances.

Table 4. Equivalence scale to be applied to the Indicator of Economic Situation (ISE)

Number of family members	Parameters
1	1
2	1.57
3	2.04
4	2.46
5	2.85*

* For households with more than 5 members, the parameter is increased by 0.35 for each member above the fifth. Moreover, the parameters shown in Table 2 are increased by:

- 0.2 for lone parents with children.
- 0.5 for each disabled member of the household.
- 0.2 for couples with children, when both parents are working.

Source: Legislative Decree n. 109 of 18 June 1998.

The allowance for households with at least three children aged less than 18 amounts to EUR 135.43 per month (EUR 1,760.59 per year), and is granted to households whose ISE lies below a threshold. With reference to a five-member family this threshold is 24,377.39 and, as for the maternity allowance, is modified according to the ISE equivalence scale (table 4).

The total amount of the benefit is provided in the case whereby total ISE is smaller than or equal to the difference between the threshold and the value of the maximum benefit. The benefit is paid on a reduced base when total ISE lies between the difference between the threshold and the yearly amount and the threshold.

This benefit and the maternity allowance as well as the corresponding thresholds, are adjusted yearly to the consumer price index. Both benefits are administered at the local level and provided by INPS on behalf of municipalities.

6.2.1.1 Irregular additional payments

6.2.2 Income and earnings disregards

As explained above in assessing family allowances total household taxable income is considered; however, the benefit is granted only if at least 70 per cent of the income stems from wages and salaries and former-employees' pensions.

Social card: the income concept relevant for the benefit eligibility is taxable income. Income from the main house of residence is included in this base.

6.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

Family allowances, the maternity allowance, the allowance for households with at least three children under age are exempt from income taxation.

6.4 Treatment of particular groups

Both the income brackets and the amounts of allowances to dependent workers are modified whenever disabled people and/or lone parents are present within the family.

The equivalence scale set for mother allowances and for allowance to households with at least three children is modified when there are disabled people and/or lone parents within the family and/or when both parents work (see Table 4). Moreover, households with disabled members and/or with children have a priority right for the minimum income support benefit.

Free books and scholarships are provided to students belonging to families with an ISEE below a given threshold, varying with the family size according to the ISE equivalence scale (Table 4).

6.4.1 Young persons

6.4.2 Older workers

6.4.3 Others if applicable

7. Childcare for pre-school children

Childcare provisions for children 0-3 years old are administered at the municipal level. They have a very high degree of variability at national level, as well as at regional level and even for the same province or municipality. Therefore it is not possible to identify a "representative" case. Furthermore, there is no guarantee that such services are actually provided (or financed) by the public administration depending on the amount of available resources.

7.1 Out-of-pocket childcare fees paid by parents

Full-time childcare

The rebates of out-of-pocket childcare fees paid by parents is not universally provided but eventually administered at municipal level. In some cases a means-tested voucher is paid by local administrations in order to cover such expenditures, under the condition of using it only in certified institutions. This holds for children 0-3 years old. In the pre-school years, childcare services are offered almost universally and are free of charge for the families.

Part-time childcare

N/A

7.2 Child-care benefits for formal centre-based care

Child-care services are essentially nurseries for children below 3 years of age. They are provided according to rules set by regional laws and implemented at municipal level with different criteria. These provisions mainly consist of in-kind means-tested benefits. Generally speaking, the household income and composition are considered to rank eligibility and fees. Above 3 years of age, while not compulsory, the public system provides for an almost universal and free of charge coverage (except for food) through the State and municipal "maternal" schools.

7.2.1 Conditions for receipt

7.2.2 Calculation of benefit amount

7.2.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

7.2.2.2 Income and earnings disregards

7.2.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

7.2.4 Treatment of particular groups

7.3 Child care allowance for children not using child care centers

8. Employment-conditional benefits

Assegno sociale: the benefit amounts to EUR 442.30 per month (thirteen payments in one year) for income not exceeding EUR 5,749.70 (in case of non married recipients) and EUR 11,499.80 (if related to a couple). The benefit is paid on a differential basis, is exempted from taxation, .

Family allowances described in section 6 are actually employment-conditional benefit. Supplementary benefits (*Integrazioni al Minimo*) for low-income households are granted to recipients of old-age and survivors' pensions whenever their accrued benefits fall short of a statutory minimum, set to EUR 495.43 per month. Eligibility for the supplementary benefits requires that the claimant's personal taxable income - if married, both partners' cumulated incomes - be below a given threshold. Beneficiaries receive the full amount if income is lower than EUR 6,440.59, a reduced amount if income is lower than EUR 12,881.18 (respectively, EUR 19,321.77 and EUR 25,762.36 if married). While the 1995 main pension reform abolished supplementary benefits for new enrolees, no changes were introduced for all the other cases.

8.1 Conditions for receipt

8.2 Calculation of benefit amount

8.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

8.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

8.4 Benefit duration

8.5 Treatment of particular group

8.5.1 Young persons

8.5.2 Older workers

8.5.3 Others if applicable

9. Lone-parent benefits

Lone parents are entitled to the family allowances described in section 6.

9.1 *Conditions for receipt*

9.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

9.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

9.2.1.1 *Irregular additional payments*

9.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

9.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

9.4 *Benefit duration*

9.5 *Treatment of particular group*

9.5.1 *Young persons*

9.5.2 *Older workers*

9.5.3 *Others if applicable*

10. Tax system**10.1 Income tax****10.1.1 Tax allowances and credits**

Specific tax credits are provided for pensioners. The Italian income tax system allows tax credits decreasing in income and varying with the income source (dependent work, self-employment, pensions). Such credits actually play an important role as the maximum eligible amount defines the no-tax area, that is the tax exemption threshold. This amounts to EUR 8000 for employees, EUR 7500 for pensioners, EUR 7750 for pensioners aged over 75, 4800 for self-employed.

10.1.1.1 Standard allowances

Social security contributions due by law

10.1.1.2 Standard tax credits

All the tax credits in Italy are non-refundable.

- Standard tax credits

The PAYE tax credit is defined as a function of net income:

Taxable income (EUR)	PAYE tax credit (EUR)
Up to 8 000	1 840
From 8 001 to 15 000	Maximum tax credit + $502 \times (15\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 7\,000$
From 15 001 to 55 000	Maximum tax credit $\times (55\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 40\,000$
More than 55 000	0

The maximum value for the tax credit depends on the level of taxable income:

Level of taxable income (EUR)	Maximum tax credit (EUR)
From 8 001 to 15 000	1 338
From 15 001 to 23 000	1 338
From 23 001 to 24 000	1 348
From 24 001 to 25 000	1 358
From 25 001 to 26 000	1 368
From 26 001 to 27 700	1 378
From 27 701 to 28 000	1 363
From 28 001 to 55 000	1 338

- Tax credits for family dependents

The tax credits for family dependants, which have replaced the former tax allowances, are as follows:

Family tax credits (EUR) *	Amount (EUR)
Spouse	800 decreasing to 0 for net income over 80 000
Children Under three years of age Over three years of age	1220 decreasing to 0 for net income over 95 000 950 decreasing to 0 for net income over 95 000
Other dependent relatives	750 decreasing to 0 for net income over 80 000
(*) Tax credits are granted for family dependents earning less than EUR 2 840.51	

The spouse tax credit is calculated as a function of net income:

Level of taxable income (EUR)	Amount of tax credit (EUR)
Up to 15 000	$800 - 110 \times \text{taxable income} / 15\,000$
From 15 001 to 29 000	690
From 29 001 to 29 200	700
From 29 201 to 34 700	710
From 34 701 to 35 000	720
From 35 001 to 35 100	710
From 35 101 to 35 200	700
From 35 201 to 40 000	690
From 40 001 to 80 000	$690 \times (80\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 40\,000$
More than 80 000	0

The child tax credit is calculated as a function of net income:

- for families with only one child: $950 \times (95\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 95\,000$;
- for families with more than one child the amount of 95 000 is increased by 15 000 for each child other than the first, for every children (including the first one).

Families with more than 3 children receive an additional tax credit of EUR 200 per child.

A lone parent receives an actual tax credit for the first child equal to the maximum of the spouse tax credit and the child tax credit.

Tax credits for children have to be equally shared between the parents; different shares are no longer allowed.

If the spouse's tax liable net of the PAYE tax credit is less than his/her share (50 per cent) in the child tax credit, the entire child tax credit is provided to the principal earner.

10.1.2 *Income tax schedule (central government income tax)*

The following tax schedule is applied to taxable income:

Bracket (EUR)		Rate (%)
up to	15 000	23
over	15 000 up to 28 000	27
over	28 000 up to 55 000	38
over	55 000 up to 75 000	41
over	75 000	43

Decree-Law n. 138 of 13th August 2011 introduced the “Contributo di Solidarietà” for the 2011-2013 tax periods, that is a 3% “solidarity contribution” on the portion of income higher than 300.000 euros (the amount paid is deductible from PIT base)”

10.1.3 *State and local income taxes*

10.1.3.1 *Regional surcharge tax*

This surcharge tax has been introduced in 1997. The tax is levied by each region on resident taxpayers' total taxable income at a discretionary rate, which must fall within an established range. As from the year 2000 this range is 0.9 per cent – 1.4 per cent.

In December 2011, with the DL 201/2011, the minimum state rate has been increased from 0.9% to 1.23%

The figure given in the 2013 parameter values table under the heading “Regional and local tax” includes the regional surcharge tax paid in the most representative city which is Rome (Lazio); the rate is 1.73 per cent in 2013.

10.1.3.2 *Local surcharge tax*

This surcharge tax has been introduced in 1999. The tax may be levied by each local government at an initial rate that cannot exceed 0.2 per cent. If the tax is levied, the local government can increase the initial rate, on a yearly basis, up to a maximum of 0.5 per cent. Each yearly increase cannot exceed 0.2 per cent. As from 2012, municipalities can increase the rate up to 0.8. A 0.9 special rate can be introduced by Roma Capitale Local Government.

The figure given in the 2013 parameter values table under the heading “Regional and local tax” includes the local surcharge tax paid in the most representative city which is Rome; the rate is 0.9 per cent in 2013.

10.2 *Treatment of family income*

Income tax is assessed on an individual basis. However presence of a dependent spouse as well as dependent children is taken into account through specific tax credits. Dependent individuals must earn income below EUR 2840.51, provided that live within the family and or receive alimony checks. The tax

credit for dependent spouse decreases with before tax individual income net of cadastral rent from the main house of residence.

10.3 Social security contributions and payroll taxes

10.3.1 Contributions payable by employees and benefit recipients

- Rate and ceiling
 - The average rate is 9.49 per cent on earnings up to EUR 45 430.
 - The average rate is 10.49 per cent on earnings over EUR 45 430 and up to EUR 99 034.
 - For earnings exceeding EUR 99 034, the employee pays a fixed amount given by $(0.0949 \times 45\,430) + 0.1049 \times (99\,034 - 45\,430)$.
- Distinction by marital status or sex
 - None.

10.3.2 Contributions payable by employers

- Contributions equal 32.08 per cent on earnings up to EUR 99 034. For earnings exceeding EUR 99 034, the employer pays a fixed amount given by $0.3208 \times 99\,034$.

10.3.3 Payroll taxes

10.4 Treatment of particular group

10.4.1 Young persons

10.4.2 Older workers

10.4.3 Others if applicable

11. Part-time work

11.1 *Special benefit rules for part-time work*

11.2 *Special tax and social security contribution rules for part-time work*

12. Policy developments

12.1 *Policy changes introduced: 2nd July 2012– 1st July 2013*

After a new Government took office in November 2011, some important reforms were enacted in order to reduce the public deficit (as well as public debt) and at the same time to foster firms' competitiveness. Here we focus on the reform of the unemployment benefits scheme, on the pensions reform, on the introduction of a property tax.

The unemployment benefits reform will be introduced gradually starting in 2013 and it will be in full operation in 2017. This reform will change the actual scheme in a radical way. The new *Assicurazione Sociale per l'Impiego* (ASPI), Social Insurance for Employment, will replace ordinary unemployment benefits, CIG and mobility benefits. The monthly benefit amounts to 75% of the previous pay for wages below EUR 1,180, while for wages higher than this threshold the benefit is increased by 25% of the difference between the worker's wage and this threshold. However, the maximum amount cannot exceed a given amount defined by the Law. The benefit is reduced by 15% after the first six months of unemployment, 30% in the following six months. Workers must have paid social insurance contributions for at least one year in the period prior unemployment.

The contributory method introduced in 1995 for new enrollees, but on a partial basis for workers who had paid contributions for more less than 18 years, will be applied to all workers starting in January 2012. The reform also changes the retirement age for women (62 increased gradually to 66 up to 2018), actually equalizing women retirement age to men.

As it concerns the personal tax system a new property tax was introduced in 2012, the *Imposta Comunale sugli Immobili* (IMU) that replaces ICI (*Imposta Comunale sugli Immobili*), abolished in 2008 for the main house of residence. The ordinary rate of taxation is 0,4% for the main house and 0,76% for other properties. The final tax rate is defined by each municipality within a given range. The law provides a relief of EUR 200.00 for the main house of residence, increased by EUR 50 for each child aged less than 26 years living in the household.

12.2 *Future policy changes announced since 1st July 2013*

The main reform introduced in 2013 concerns the definition of the Indicator per la Situazione Economica Equivalente (Indicator for the Economic Situation, ISEE), a combined income-wealth indicator originally introduced in 1998 as a means-testing criterion to evaluate access to specific social services.

The indicator takes into account household income and 20% of household (financial and property) wealth and uses the ISE equivalence scale reported in Table 4. More precisely, ISEE can be defined as follows:

$$\text{ISEE} = (\text{Household Income} + 0.20 \text{ Household Wealth}) / \text{Equivalence Scale}$$

After the 2013 reform income also includes exempted income, originally excluded in the computation, though specific deductions are granted to households with disabled persons. Also, the reform introduced

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2013**

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some modifications in the calculation of property wealth basing on the changes enacted after the introduction of the Imposta Municipale sugli Immobili (Municipal Property Tax, IMU) in 2013. These changes will probably improve targeting of the scheme as a means-testing criterion.

Finally, the reform has also strengthened the powers of local authorities to check truthfulness of recipients self-declaration.

The ISEE applies to evaluate beneficiaries' access to local welfare measures, such as: child care (nursery school), school canteens, health services.

ANNEX

DEFINITION OF SOCIAL SECURITY CONTRIBUTIONS AND PAYROLL TAXES.

The following text has been adapted from Annex A of the OECD *Revenue Statistics*.

Social security contributions to general government

Classified here are all compulsory payments that confer an entitlement to receive a (contingent) future social benefit. Such payments are usually earmarked to finance social benefits and are often paid to institutions of general government that provide such benefits. However, such earmarking is not part of the definition of social security contributions and is not required for a tax to be classified here. However, conferment of an entitlement is required for a tax to be classified under this heading. So, levies on income or payroll that are earmarked for social security funds but do not confer an entitlement to benefit are excluded from this heading and shown under personal income taxes or taxes on payroll and workforce. Taxes on other bases, such as goods and services, which are earmarked for social security benefits are not shown here [...] because they generally confer no entitlement to social security benefits.

Contributions for the following types of social security benefits would, *inter alia*, be included: unemployment insurance benefits and supplements, accident, injury and sickness benefits, old-age, disability and survivors' pensions, family allowances, reimbursements for medical and hospital expenses or provision of hospital or medical services. Contributions may be levied on both employees and employers.

Social security contributions paid to institutions outside general government

Contributions to social insurance schemes which are not institutions of general government and to other types of insurance schemes, provident funds, pension funds, friendly societies or other saving schemes [are included here if they are compulsory or quasicompulsory (e.g., by virtue of agreement with professional and union organisations)]. Provident funds are arrangements under which the contributions of each employee and of the corresponding employer on his/her behalf are kept in a separate account earning interest and withdrawable under specific circumstances. Pension funds are separately organised schemes negotiated between employees and employers and carry provisions for different contributions and benefits, sometimes more directly tied to salary levels and length of service than under social security schemes.

Payroll taxes

This heading covers taxes paid by employers or employees either as a proportion of payroll or as a fixed amount per person, and which do not confer entitlement to social benefits. Examples of taxes classified here are the United Kingdom national insurance surcharge (introduced in 1977), the Swedish payroll tax (1969-1979), and the Austrian Contribution to the Family Burden Equalisation Fund and Community Tax.